

Legal Hold Preservation Guidance

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Use notice. This is an internally synthesized training document. Aurora Federation, Harbor State, Aster Legal, Matter Alpha, and every source cited here are fictional. It is not legal advice or a statement of current law.

Purpose

An operational guide for preserving relevant data while respecting privacy limitations and minimizing collection outside a defined matter.

Scope and boundary

Matter Alpha anchor: preserve 42 identified records as of 2026-06-30. Any exception request is due 2026-07-12 and must be documented before deletion or scope reduction.

Rule summary

A legal hold suspends routine disposition for defined relevant material. It requires precise scope, auditable preservation, controlled exceptions, and a counsel-approved release; it does not authorize indiscriminate collection.

Decision path

Step	Required action
1	Define scope Name the matter, custodians or systems, date range, data classes, and excluded sources.
2	Issue hold Deliver a plain-language notice, capture acknowledgment, and configure preservation with the system owner.
3	Monitor exceptions Track unavailable sources, duplicate sets, and proportionality concerns; do not silently release data.
4	Release carefully Counsel approves release only after confirming the matter hold and any regulator preservation need are closed.

Operating controls

Escalation trigger

Escalate immediately if routine deletion conflicts with the 42-record hold, if a system cannot preserve in place, or if an exception lacks counsel approval by 2026-07-12.

Recordkeeping

Maintain the notice, acknowledgment log, preservation configuration, exception decision, collection chain log, and release authorization.

Roles and cadence

Business owner supplies complete facts and implements controls. Privacy Legal verifies the review path, decision rationale, and escalation. Records Management maintains retention evidence. Reassess on a material change, a new recipient or system, a control failure, or the scheduled annual review.

Fictional source register

Reference	Fictional use
Aurora Federation Privacy Framework, 2026 edition	Synthetic baseline for purpose limitation, accountability, and transfer review.
Harbor State Information Stewardship Rules, guidance note 4	Synthetic comparison point for notification, processor, and records controls.
Aster Legal Matter Alpha control register, 2026-06-30	Synthetic operational anchor for preservation target 42 and exception workflow.

Decision record minimum

Record the request or event, scope, facts relied upon, rule path, decision maker, conditions, escalation outcome, review date, and storage location. Do not include personal data, credentials, or privileged source material in this guidance record.